

 De La Salle University	Research Ethics Review Committee Research Ethics Office, 3F Henry Sy Sr. Hall De La Salle University Manila 2401 Taft Avenue, Manila 1004, Philippines REO@dlsu.edu.ph (632) 524-4611 loc. 513	SOP No.: 2
		Form No.: 2(K)
		Version No.: 1
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Checklist G

Research Ethics Checklist for Investigators conducting Internet Research

*This checklist must be completed **AFTER** the De La Salle University Code of Research Ethics and Guide to Responsible Conduct of Research has been read and **BEFORE** gathering data. The University Code of Research Ethics is available at http://www.dlsu.edu.ph/offices/urco/forms/URCO-Code-of-Research-Ethics_August2011.pdf*

NOTE: This checklist is completed after the research proponent fills out the General Checklist Form and Checklist A.

Only answer this Checklist if you are conducting Internet Research (research on online communities).

Which of the following online data will you be using in your research? Check all that apply:

- ☒ Social Media Platform (e.g. Twitter, Facebook, 9gag)
- ☐ Blogs & Forum including Comments (e.g. BoredPanda, Reddit)
- ☐ E-mails & Chats
- ☐ Video Blogs (e.g. YouTube)
- ☐ Collaborative (e.g. Wikipedia)
- ☐ Websites (e.g. News, Media, Company, E-Commerce, Government, etc.)
- ☐ Online Recruitment Platform (e.g. Mechanical Turk, Freelancer, E-lance, O-Desk)
- ☐ Open Source Websites (e.g. GitHub)
- ☐ Others: _____

Where will you source your data?

- ☒ New
- ☐ Existing
- ☐ Combination

What type of data will be collected?

- ☒ Text
- ☒ Audio
- ☒ Video/Film
- ☐ Photo
- ☒ Metadata (e.g. Profile, Geographic Location, Tags)

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☐ Presentations (e.g. downloaded PowerPoint or Keynote presentations) ☐ Contents of an application such as input, output, log files for analysis software, simulation software, schemas ☐ Correspondence, including electronic mail
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What is the period coverage of data collection? (indicate in years and months) 1 year and 1 month (March 25, 2026, to April 16, 2027) How many participants will you collect data from? 30 to 50 active TikTok content creators. What are all the websites you will source your data from? Please list all URLs: TikTok: https://www.tiktok.com TikTok Studio: https://www.tiktok.com/tiktokstudio/content

How will informed consent be obtained? Please check. ☒ Electronic Information Sheet with "check box" for consent ☒ E-mail with name ☐ Consent implied through submitting information ☐ Written Consent ☐ Audio-recorded Consent ☐ Others: _____ How will the participants obtain a copy of the informed consent form? Please check. ☐ Hard copy ☒ Online copy (If online copies will be given, the users should be able to click on the Print button incorporated in the information page, or an e-mail should be sent to the participant containing the agreement form.)
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If a participant wishes to leave the study and wishes to withdraw the submitted information, describe the steps a participant must take to withdraw from the study in the research proposal and in the informed consent form.

Participants may withdraw by emailing the research team at the contact provided in the consent form.

Withdrawal requests will be honored at any time before the final model aggregation phase. Upon request, all submitted files linked to the participant will be permanently deleted from the research drive within 5 business days.

	Yes	No	Not Applicable
1. Is the data you are planning to gather publicly available? If NO...attach a letter of support from the website or server owner/moderator indicating approval to use this for data gathering Note: Data is not gathered from publicly accessible pages. It is obtained through voluntary donation by the creators themselves from their private TikTok analytics dashboard. Participation is fully consent-based; creators retain ownership and initiate the export on their own device.	✓		
2. Will the participants be compensated for participating? If YES...indicate the type of compensation to be provided and provide information on how appropriate and just compensation (proportionate to the contribution in the research, research budget, and local conditions) will be provided.		✓	
3. Will you have minors as participants in your study? Minors are individuals under the age of 18 years old. If YES...Obtain parental/guardian consent and participant assent to participate in your study. Attach the parental consent and assent forms to your proposal. The consent forms should indicate the measures you will undertake to ensure		✓	

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confidentiality and protect the participants. The electronic versions of the consent forms are acceptable.			
4. Will data collection involve students? If YES... let the participant sign an informed consent form that assures that his/her academic status will not be affected by participation or non-participation in the study.			✓
5. Will data collection involve persons who belong to a vulnerable group (PWDs, minorities, abuse victims, students, etc.) If YES... ensure that the participants are briefed about the study and the data gathering protocols, and will be provided special assistance should they require it. Please submit a corresponding detailed research protocol.		✓	
	Yes	No	Not Applicable
6. Will data be collected using an automated system? (e.g. hardware, software, or meta search engines) If YES... provide details on the automation system (web crawler, etc.)		✓	
7. Will there be information about the study that will be deliberately withheld from the participants? If YES... what information will be withheld, what are the benefits for doing so, and how will debriefing be done?		✓	
8. Will your data be stored after this study? If YES, please indicate in the research proposal how long data will be stored, and how it will be stored. Include this information in the informed consent form and provide a plan for data confidentiality. Identified data: retained for a maximum of two years, counted from the first publication of any result derived from the dataset or from project completion, whichever is later, then	✓		

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securely deleted. Anonymized feature sets and model weights: retained for a maximum of three years on the same basis, on an encrypted, password-protected drive, in line with standard academic reproducibility protocols.			
9. Will the data be made available for future research? If YES... indicate in the informed consent form that the results of the study will be used for future studies.		✓	
10. Will you anonymize the participants in your data? If YES...provide details on how you will assure the confidentiality and anonymity of the participants. Pseudonymous ID assignment: Each participant's TikTok handle and account ID are stripped from the raw exported CSV files and replaced with a randomized code before the data is processed or stored in the model pipeline.	✓		
11. Will the results of this study have a commercial value? If yes, do you intend to apply for a patent for the output of this research? Please check: ____ Yes ____ No		✓	